



The latest 8-GB iPod Nano with a built-in camera is priced at Rs. 9,400



Once released, Windows Mobile 6.5 will be found on Samsung's Omnia series of smartphones

# Linksys WRT320N Wireless Router

A futuristic looking dual-band router



The Linksys WRT320N router is part of the modern design series that parent company Cisco envisioned. The WRT320N maintains the slim profile of its predecessor, the WRT310N, as well as the futuristic styling. The build is sturdy yet it looks great. This is one of the few routers available today that comes without antennas protruding. It supports the latest Draft-N Wi-Fi standard. The main difference in this revised model is the addition of a dual band – which operates at 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz as well. The router has a easy-to-use firmware interface. It supports automatic bandwidth allocation depending on the application being used.

Coming to the performance, we connected a Dell XPS Studio 13 wirelessly to the router. A dedicated system

acted as the server and the router was connected to it by wire. Two separate zones were setup - one where the laptop was placed right next to the router and the other where the laptop was placed some 25ft away. From the tests we ran, we could conclude that the router is above average in

terms of performance. The range and reception isn't that great either.

At Rs. 8,999, it's an expensive router. Other than the sleek design, it does not bring any unique features to the table that could interest the casual user such as USB support for example.

| Zone 1 (100 MB File transfer)                   |               |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Signal Strength in Zone 1 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %) | 70            |
| Sequential (MBps)                               | 4             |
| Assorted files (MBps)                           | 2.08          |
| Zone 2 (50 MB File transfer)                    |               |
| Signal Strength in Zone 2 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %) | 40            |
| Sequential (MBps)                               | 5             |
| Assorted files (MBps)                           | 4.77          |
| Zone 3 (50 MB File transfer)                    |               |
| Signal Strength in Zone 3 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %) | 5             |
| Sequential (MBps)                               | N/A           |
| Assorted files (MBps)                           | N/A           |
| Passmark Performance Test Zone 1 / Zone 2       | 54.32 / 20.86 |
| Video Streaming (HD 1080p) Zone 1 / Zone 2      | 9 / 8         |
| Video Streaming (DVD) Zone 1 / Zone 2           | 9 / 9         |

## Contact

**Linksys Corporation**

**Phone:** +91-98204 29532

**Email:**

jdabrai@cisco.com

**Web site:** www.linksysbycisco.com

**Price:** Rs. 8,999

## Specifications

**LAN ports:** WAN x 1, LAN x 4 RJ-45

**Frequency:** 2.4 GHz or 5 GHz

**Standards:** Draft 802.11n v2.0, 802.11g, 802.11b, 802.3, 802.3u, 802.3ab

**Size:** 202 x 34 x 160 mm

**Weight:** 300 g

## RATINGS

|                       |   |
|-----------------------|---|
| Features .....        | 7 |
| Performance .....     | 6 |
| Build quality .....   | 7 |
| Value for money ..... | 4 |
| Overall .....         | 6 |

# Apple iPod Shuffle

## Shuffling around

It's that time again and new apples are beginning to fall from, well, Apple trees. This one is really compact and elongated, whereas the previous one was square. The full metal body has an anodised finish and the belt clip is rugged. Gone are the controls on the body and there's just one power switch that doubles as a

track shuffle. Sadly Apple has moved the volume controls to the earphone cord so you can kiss using other headphones goodbye – in our opinion this borders on arm-twisting users to use only Apples earphones. There's a nifty voice based navigation feature that can tell you the name of your playlist and can also tell you the name of the artist or the title of a song while it's playing – neat and obviously meant to make up for the lack of a screen. However you need to download a voice over pack for this via iTunes.

Because of the controls being on the earphones it's impossible to test the device with any other



headphones and quite frankly Apples own headphones are not for purists. However, the earphones do belt out a pretty high volume. At Rs. 4,900, the new iPod Shuffle 4 GB is for someone looking for a really tiny MP3 player for music and nothing else.

## Contact

**Apple India**

**Phone:** 1800-425-0744

**Email:** indiasales@mac.com

**Web site:** www.apple.co.in

**Price:** Rs. 4,900

## Specifications

**Capacity:** 4 GB

**Weight:** 10.7 g

**Frequency response:** 20 Hz to 20 KHz

**Audio formats:** AAC, MP3, WAV, ALAC, AIFF

## RATINGS

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Features .....        | 6   |
| Performance .....     | 7.5 |
| Build quality .....   | 8.5 |
| Value for money ..... | 6.5 |
| Overall .....         | 7   |